

Ethical Considerations in use of ICT Platforms and tools

SUBJECT : Introduction to Information and Communication Technologies

COURSE CODE : IT-1502

BATCH : 2025/fall

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Introduction

- ICT provides powerful tools for creating, sharing, and using information.
- With this power comes responsibility.
- Ethical behavior ensures trust, fairness, and respect in digital environments.

Why Ethics in ICT?

- Prevents misuse of digital content
- Protects creators' rights
- Ensures safe and truthful online communication
- Promotes responsible digital citizenship

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY & COPYRIGHT

What Is Intellectual Property (IP)?

- Intellectual Property refers to creative works like:
 - Text
 - Images
 - Software
 - Music
 - Videos
- IP laws protect creators from misuse or theft of their work.

Understanding Copyright

- Copyright gives legal protection to original content.
- Prevents unauthorized copying, distribution, or modification.
- Applies automatically once content is created.

Common Copyright Violations

- Copying images without permission
- Downloading pirated movies or software
- Using music without proper license
- Republishing someone's article as your own

How to Respect Copyright

- Use copyright-free or Creative Commons material
- Give proper credit (citation)
- Ask permission for copyrighted content
- Create your own original work when possible

ORIGINALITY & PLAGIARISM

What Is Plagiarism?

- Using someone else's work, ideas, text, or images
- Without credit or permission
- Presenting it as your own
- Considered unethical and dishonest

Examples of Plagiarism

- Copy–paste from websites
- Using another student’s assignment
- Paraphrasing without citing sources
- Using AI-generated text without acknowledgment (if required)

Ensuring Originality

- Write content in your own words
- Cite all sources properly
- Use plagiarism-checking tools
- Keep track of all references used
- Understand the topic before writing

Ethical Use of Information

- Verify source credibility
- Avoid unauthorized use of documents, photos, or videos
- Follow fair use guidelines
- Respect privacy when using personal information

CONTENT ACCURACY & INTEGRITY

What Is Content Accuracy?

- Content must be **correct, factual, and reliable**.
- Especially important in news, education, and public communication.

Misinformation vs Fake News

- **Misinformation:** False information shared unknowingly
- **Fake News:** Deliberately fabricated stories to mislead people
- ICT makes it easy for false information to spread quickly

Ensuring Content Integrity

- Double-check facts before sharing
- Use credible sources (govt, academic, reputable news)
- Avoid editing information in misleading ways
- Think critically before forwarding messages

Responsibilities of an Ethical ICT User

- Share truthful information
- Respect creators' rights
- Maintain originality
- Avoid spreading harmful or false content
- Be accountable for your digital actions

Conclusion

- Ethical use of ICT builds trust and supports safe digital spaces.
- Respecting copyright, avoiding plagiarism, and ensuring accuracy are essential.
- Everyone must act responsibly when creating and sharing digital content.